

cmf watch Pro

Nothing special

Colour. Material. Finish. In industrial design terms, "CMF" usually denotes the chromatic, tactile, and decorative character of products.

We're not 100% certain that that's what Nothing had in mind when its new sub-brand cmf was founded. However, take one look at the Watch pro's premium-looking bright orange strap and chrome body, and one can definitely hazard a guess.

FEATURES

Straight out of the box, the Watch pro comes with a fairly standard set of features seen in most smartwatches.

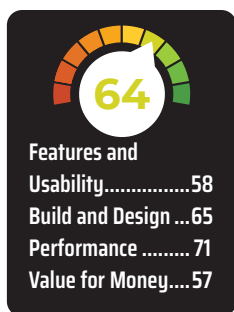
There's a 1.96" AMOLED screen that sports a 410 x 502 display with 332ppi and a 58fps refresh rate. It comes with a removable 22mm silicon wrist strap in bright neon orange. Its 340mAh battery is charged with a proprietary charging cable (comes in the packaging) and advertises an impressive 13 days of typical use, and claims 45 days when in power saver mode.

The cmf Watch Pro comes with an IP68 rating along with 110 sports modes, 24-hour heart-rate and blood oxygen monitoring. It also monitors your sleep, stress and reminds you to stand up and drink water regularly. Sporting Bluetooth v5.3, the watch can take calls via bluetooth; and though the advertised AI noise reduction of its built-in mic isn't the greatest, it's nice to have.

All-in-all, the watch comes with some good hardware and like we said before: a fairly standard set of features we're used to seeing in smartwatches from the budget segment.

BUILD & DESIGN

The cmf Watch Pro balances a rugged



build with what can only be described as a polarising design. People who like less flashy, sober designs may find themselves detesting the shiny frame, wide bezel and neon orange strap, which scream 'I'm right here. Look at me!'

Personally, while the wide bezel and chrome frame did feel a bit dated – as did the rather large speaker openings and the early 2000s silver button – the overall look and feel of the watch didn't bother me, as such. The out-of-the-box strap also has an unusual design. While I quite liked how secure it sits on my wrist, others in the office did find it cumbersome to put on.

The watch weighs in at about 47g, which is a tad heavier than other smartwatches in its category. Its sleek AMOLED display is protected by a tough glass panel. Its aluminium alloy frame and hard plastic back have a reassuring sturdiness to them. Despite its slightly heavier build, the build of the watch does allow you to comfortably use the watch in day-to-day activities without worrying about damaging it.

To be honest, I was worried about how well its IP68 rating would count for, considering those really large speaker holes. However, after using it over a month – through regular exercise, hand-washing and showers – the watch held its own, as did its speakers.

PERFORMANCE

In terms of performance, the cmf Watch Pro did a strictly decent job, considering its price point and segment. Its heart rate, step count and SpO2 tracking accuracy matched up to best of our testing standards. In fact, in terms of SpO2 tracking, the watch did a better job than some premium smartwatches. Its 14-day (ish) battery life is also higher than most smartwatches in the market today, which is a definite plus.

Its health tracking did leave a lot to be desired, though. Its calorie tracking falls short. The watch displayed a 65.51% accuracy in our 2km walking tests. Considering the Hammer Conquer (our Zero1 Best Buy winner this year) manages a 75.81% accuracy at a price point that's 40% lower than the cmf Watch, this does seem like something the brand may want to try and improve upon.

Sleep tracking was problematic and erratic. This could be due to the teething pains that new products usually face, but at the time of testing the watch (which is about two months after launch) the watch wasn't very good at tracking sleep. Some of these issues are app UI based (which we'll double back to in the next section) but there were a few times when I took the watch off and kept it on a table for an hour or two here and there, which the watch promptly logged as short 'naps' – which did seem like a glaring problem for anyone who uses their smartwatch for regular sleep tracking.

Additionally, the watch's display also tested a maximum brightness of 520 Nits, at least 80 Nits lower than the brand's claimed brightness of '600+ Nits'. However, compared to other watches in the segment, 520 Nits is still quite bright.